

MSc / MPhil Option Course - Hilary Term 2027 - Department of Sociology, Oxford

Sociology of Education

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France

France braces for national day of school protests as boy loses hand

Thousands expected to join marches of support on Tuesday across the country amid growing concerns over police response

● [Europe live - latest updates](#)



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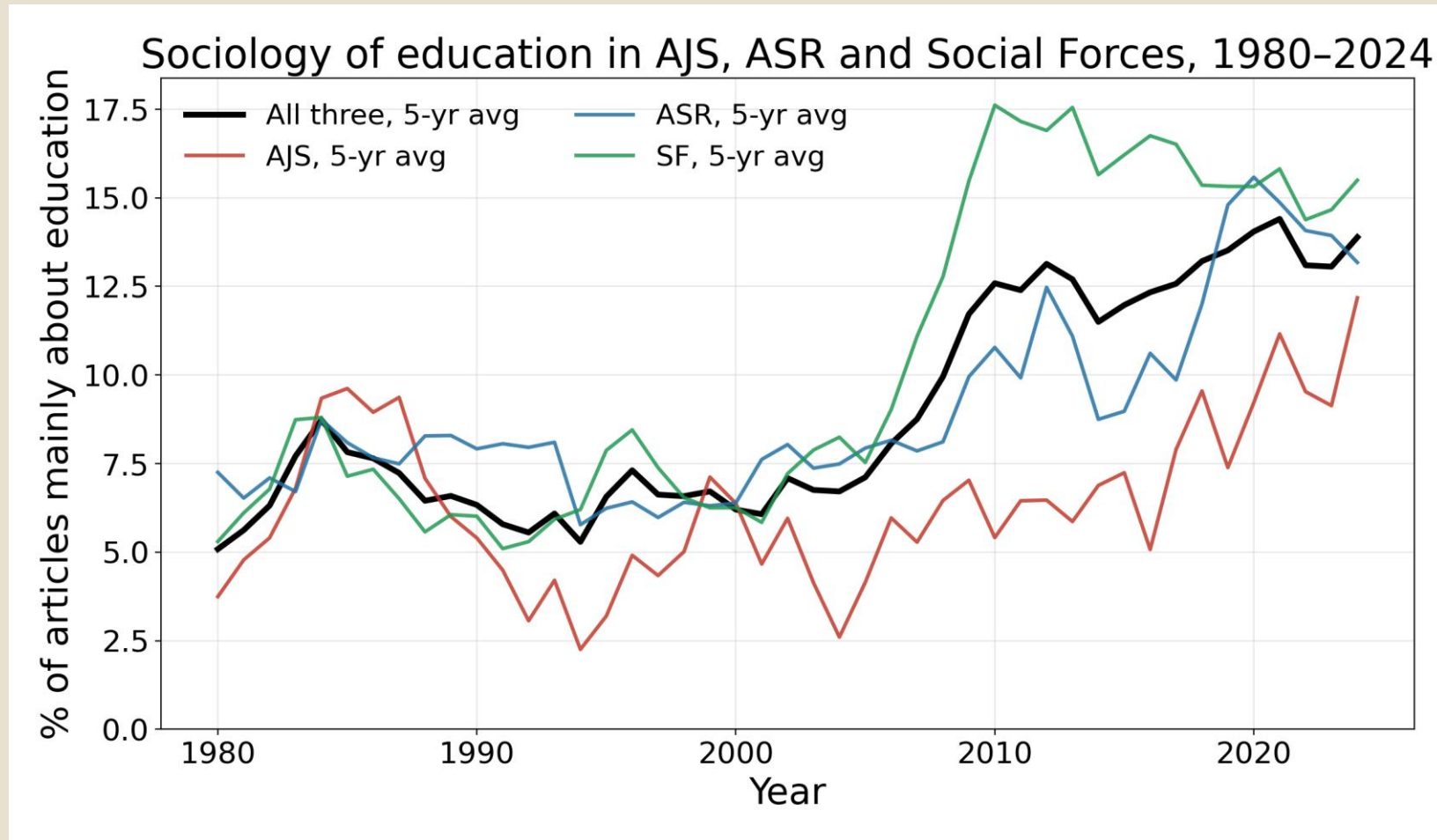
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Schools

England school inspections to be overhauled again after barrage of complaints

Exclusive: Education secretary sends Ofsted back to 'drawing board' as teachers raise serious concerns about new system

Sociology of Education



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Core themes

- Why did mass education emerge and spread globally?
- Meritocracy and the “signaling value” of a degree
- Do schools primarily reduce or reproduce inequality (race, class, gender, ...)

Interdisciplinary perspective

Sociology

Cultural capital, schools and reproduction, social networks

Economics

Human capital, teacher effectiveness, school choice

Education

School reform and accountability, teacher careers

Topics we will study

1 Cultural reproduction perspectives

2 Are schools the great equalizer?

3 Peer effects and social networks

4 Racial and ethnic inequalities in education

Essay 1

5 Gender and education

6 Higher education and returns to college

7 Meritocracy

8 Do educational reforms work?

Essay 2

Final exam: 2 hour unseen exam in Trinity Term (3 out of 8 questions)

SOCIOLOGY OF EDUCATION

Questions?

Course convenor

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